

METHODOLOGY-FOR-DICK

How This Study Works — and How to Refute It

Prepared for Dick O'Leary. Draft — Bob reviews before anything here is treated as sent.

What we measured

For each sealed strategy we asked two questions with one method:

1. **What did the backtest claim?** Taken verbatim from the strategy's own lockdown/seal documents, with file citations.
2. **What did the paper ledger actually record?** Taken from the production fills ledgers, with pull dates and citations.

Where both sides could be stated in the same units, we computed the ratio — the **inflation factor**. Where they could not, we **refused** and said exactly why. A refusal is a finding, not a gap: it means the claim cannot currently be checked against reality, which is itself the problem this study exists to expose.

The two dimensions

- **Return inflation** (claimed %/yr ÷ realized %/yr) — computable only when both sides state a rate over a dated window of at least 60 days. **Zero of ten strategies passed that bar.** The reasons are itemized per strategy: ledgers with corrupted cost bases, claims that decline to state a calendar window, records never aggregated, and one strategy that has never produced a single fill.
- **Win-rate inflation** (claimed hit rate ÷ realized hit rate) — computable when the realized side has ≥30 closed trades. Four strategies qualified:

Strategy	Claimed	Realized	Inflation
High 5	92.3% (n=5,321)	45.1% (n=122)	2.05×
Automated Swing	92.2% (n=2,107)	56.7% (n=104)*	1.63×
Escalator Reclaimed Shadow	63.0% (n=349)	45.3% (n=150)	1.39×
Oakwind Swing Trader	67.7% (n=15,028)	58.7% (n=254)	1.15×

**37 of Automated Swing's 104 realized round-trips were later ruled fabricated phantom exits and voided — the realized figure is itself unreliable, in the claim's favor.*

Structural context you should hold while reading any page

A prior fleet-wide audit found **every** sealed backtest ranked its picks inside a frozen, survivor-biased universe: companies that died or delisted during the test period were erased from history before the test began. This can only inflate results, and it hits dip-buying strategies (both Oakwinds) hardest — they are precisely the strategies that would have caught the falling knives the frozen list deletes.

How to refute any page

Every number carries either an estate file citation (open the file, check the quote) or a content-addressed record hash (append-only — nothing can be silently edited). If you believe a better claim document or a cleaner realized ledger exists, name the file: the record set takes corrections as *supersessions*, with the original kept visible. If any excerpt is misquoted, one file citation is enough to overturn the line it supports.

What this does NOT say

This study does not say the strategy *ideas* are bad. It says the *evidence* offered for them cannot support the claims made — and in four measurable cases, the claims overstated reality by 1.15× to 2.05× on hit rate alone, before the survivorship bias is priced in. The separate Phase-3 exercise (135 pre-registered candidate variants, all run through an identical honest gauntlet: **zero survived** adversarial review) shows what the bar for a real claim now looks like.